

SCALE

What breaks first is not the process, it is shared context.

What breaks first when the team doubles in size.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

Then goes ownership, the flow and, last of all, trust.

THE CASCADE

Doubling the structure does not double the capacity.



WHAT YOU SEE

The team doubles, and you duplicate roles and rituals.



THE MECHANISM

What used to be settled in the hallway now demands a meeting with minutes.



THE CONSEQUENCE

Six months later you have twice the people and the same throughput.

You bought headcount. What was missing was installed capacity.

THE FORK

Someone says we cannot do it the old way anymore.

THE FIRST ALARM

01

Does it sound like nostalgia?

that is resistance, and it passes

02

Does it sound like a complaint?

that is a symptom, and it deserves a listen

03

Does it come with a name and an example?

that is a diagnosis, and a seam has already snapped

That sentence is the first alarm of scale, and it is almost always treated as griping.

THE METHOD

The Order of the Break, four seams.



01 SHARED CONTEXT

the first to go, nobody knows what anyone else works on

02 OWNERSHIP

turns into a fiefdom, everyone guards their own piece

03 FLOW

the hallway decision now demands an invite and minutes

04 TRUST

the last to go, and the most expensive to recover

The order matters. Whoever waits for trust to break already paid for the other three.

WHAT TO ASK, IN ORDER

Four questions that measure the seam.

01 • SHARED
CONTEXT

Who can say what the others are working on?

without opening a single tool

02 • OWNERSHIP

How many decisions stalled waiting for an owner?

in the last month, with a name and a date

03 • FLOW

How many meetings exist only to relay information?

and how many were born after the growth

04 • TRUST

Who has redone another team's work?

that is rework from distrust, not diligence

TWO MODELS

Growing in size and growing in capacity.

THE COMMON MODEL

Growing in size

Duplicates roles

Copies the old ritual

Splits by department

Measures by headcount

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Growing in capacity

Redesigns the seam that snapped

Rewrites who decides what

Splits by delivery flow

Measures by decisions that move without you

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three reactions that make it worse.

01 Duplicating the structure before redesigning the flow.

→ you buy twice the silos for twice the price.

02 Treating a fiefdom as a people problem.

→ a fiefdom is the rational answer to a badly drawn boundary.

03 Waiting for trust to break before acting.

→ it is the only seam that no process can restitch.

| The first two cost a quarter. The third costs good people.

THE CHAIN

The hallway test.

01

Think of the last decision that came out of a hallway chat.



02

Today it would demand an invite, an agenda and minutes.



03

Then the flow already snapped, and nobody announced it.

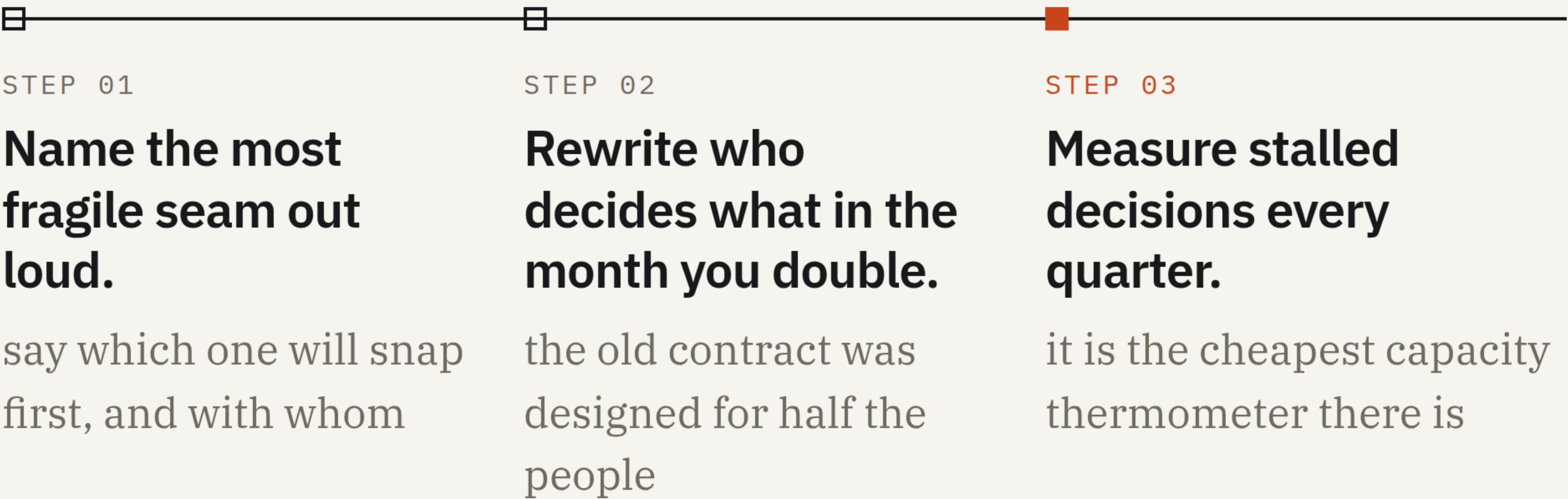


WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Every new meeting is a seam asking to be redesigned, not a sign of organization.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

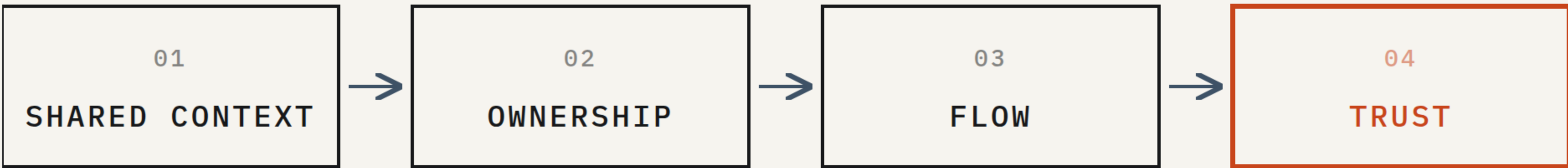
Act before you hire, not after.



Scale is not managed afterward. It is designed before the offer letter.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Four Seams, in the order that matters.



A team that doubles does not break on process. It breaks on an expired contract.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER
before the next hiring wave.

FABIO GARCIA
MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA